

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management

Sovereign Urban Regeneration Investment Memorandum

The Carlisle Renaissance Masterplan

A 25-Year Investment Strategy to Transform Carlisle into the Northern Border Capital

Prepared for:

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Urban Development & Strategic Assets Division

Executive Summary

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management proposes the creation of the:

Carlisle Renaissance Investment Programme

A long-term sovereign-style urban regeneration partnership designed to transform Carlisle into:

- The gateway between England and Scotland
- The capital of the Borderlands economy
- A northern transport hub
- A defence, energy and technology centre
- A premium heritage city

The proposal builds upon existing regeneration momentum. Cumberland Council's current Carlisle Masterplan already identifies a 25-year strategy focused on economic growth, city-centre regeneration, connectivity and placemaking. Existing regeneration activity includes station improvements, public realm investment and the University of Cumbria's Citadels Campus development.

EVWM would provide patient institutional capital to accelerate this transformation.

Investment Thesis

Carlisle has a unique strategic position:

Geography

Located at the meeting point of:

- England
- Scotland
- The Lake District
- The Irish Sea corridor

Carlisle sits at the centre of a potential economic network:

Newcastle

↓

Carlisle

↓

Glasgow / Edinburgh

↓

Barrow / West Cumbria

↓

Liverpool / Manchester

Strategic Objective

Transform Carlisle from:

A historic market city on the edge of major economies

into:

The principal northern gateway city between England, Scotland and the Irish Sea.

The Carlisle Renaissance Programme

Total Investment Proposal:

£5 billion over 25 years

Delivered through:

- EVWM investment fund
 - Pension capital
 - Private developers
 - Government partnership
 - Local enterprise investment
-

Pillar One

Carlisle Central District

"The Northern Border Quarter"

Redevelop underused city-centre areas into:

- offices
 - apartments
 - hotels
 - restaurants
 - cultural venues
 - innovation spaces
-

Vision

Create a compact, walkable northern city centre similar to:

- York
- Bath
- Edinburgh's Old Town economy

but with modern infrastructure.

Investment:

£750 million

Components:

City Living

5,000 new urban homes:

- apartments
 - townhouses
 - student accommodation
-

Commercial Quarter

Create:

Carlisle Business District

Target sectors:

- defence supply chain
 - engineering
 - financial services
 - technology
 - professional services
-

Pillar Two

Carlisle Transport Renaissance

The city becomes:

The Northern Rail Gateway

Building on existing station improvements and connectivity programmes. The current Carlisle Station Gateway project aims to improve the station environment and strengthen the city's role as a regional gateway.

Proposed Upgrades

Carlisle Grand Central Station

Transform the station into:

- intercity gateway
 - retail destination
 - business hub
-

Services:

London
Manchester
Newcastle
Glasgow
Edinburgh
Barrow
Whitehaven

Investment:

£500 million

Pillar Three

Borderlands Technology & Defence Campus

Carlisle becomes the commercial centre supporting:

- Sellafield supply chains
 - BAE Systems Barrow
 - renewable energy
 - advanced manufacturing
-

Carlisle Innovation Park

Location:

Former industrial land around transport corridors.

Facilities:

- laboratories
 - engineering workshops
 - AI/data businesses
 - university partnerships
-

Investment:

£750 million

Pillar Four

The River Eden Renaissance

Create Carlisle's equivalent of:

- Newcastle Quayside
 - Manchester waterfront regeneration
-

Transform:

River Eden corridor

into:

Carlisle Waterfront District

Components:

- riverside apartments
 - restaurants
 - parks
 - leisure
 - walking routes
 - cultural venues
-

Investment:

£600 million

Pillar Five

Historic Carlisle Restoration

Carlisle possesses exceptional heritage assets:

- Carlisle Castle
- Cathedral Quarter
- Roman heritage
- city walls

The strategy:

Turn heritage into economic infrastructure.

Programme:

"Living Heritage City"

Investment:

£300 million

Projects:

- restored historic buildings
 - boutique hotels
 - museums
 - independent retail
 - cultural events
-

Pillar Six

St Cuthbert's Garden City Expansion

Carlisle's growth requires housing.

The wider Carlisle regeneration programme already identifies major housing and infrastructure growth opportunities, including the St Cuthbert's Garden Village concept.

EVWM proposal:

A new:

Carlisle Garden City

Scale:

10,000–15,000 homes

Built around:

- rail access
 - green spaces
 - schools
 - local centres
 - renewable energy
-

Investment:

£1.5 billion

Pillar Seven

Carlisle Tourism Economy

Carlisle becomes:

The Gateway to the Lake District

Current issue:

Many visitors pass through Cumbria without staying in Carlisle.

Strategy:

Create:

Carlisle–Lake District Tourism Corridor

Investment:

£300 million

Projects:

- five-star hotels
 - conference centre
 - heritage attractions
 - cycling infrastructure
 - outdoor tourism hub
-

Economic Impact Model

Current Opportunity

Carlisle has strong strategic assets but has historically lacked the scale of investment seen in larger northern cities.

The objective is not to compete with Manchester or Newcastle.

It is to become:

The specialist northern gateway city.

Employment Impact

Construction phase:

25 years:

20,000+ jobs supported

Permanent employment:

- technology
- tourism
- offices
- education
- retail

Estimated:

10,000–15,000 additional jobs

GDP Impact

Investment:

£5 billion

Estimated productivity effect:

Improved connectivity + urban density + business clustering.

Annual economic uplift:

£750 million–£1 billion GVA

Property Value Creation

New development:

- residential
- commercial
- hospitality

Estimated land/property uplift:

£2–3 billion

Investment Structure

Carlisle Renaissance Fund

Size:

£5 billion

Capital Allocation:

Source	Contribution
EVWM	£1bn
Pension funds	£2bn
Private investors	£1bn
Government partnership	£1bn

Revenue Streams

EVWM investment returns generated through:

- commercial property
 - residential development
 - hotels
 - infrastructure assets
 - renewable energy
 - district heating
 - digital infrastructure
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Target Investment Return

Infrastructure/real estate:

7–9% long-term IRR

Strategic Importance

Carlisle becomes the anchor point for EVWM's wider Northern Britain portfolio:

Connected investments:

Rail

Preston

- Barrow
 - Whitehaven
 - Carlisle
 - Newcastle
-

Energy

Irish Sea tidal projects

Tourism

Lake District gateway

Industry

West Cumbria + Borderlands economy

Final Recommendation

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management should propose:

The Carlisle Renaissance Partnership

A sovereign-style urban investment vehicle delivering a 25-year transformation programme.

The objective:

Not simply to regenerate Carlisle.

But to establish:

Carlisle as the Northern Capital of the Borderlands.

A city where:

- historic heritage meets advanced industry
- Scotland and England connect
- the Irish Sea meets the Pennines
- defence, energy, tourism and technology converge

The next generation of northern growth requires strategic cities.

Carlisle is positioned to become one.